

1980 to 2024

Florida Presidential Elections: 1980-2024 Analysis

Comprehensive 44-year analysis of Florida voting patterns at state and county levels across 12 presidential elections.

Margin of Victory Trends:

- Republicans dominated the 1980s with consistent margins
- 1992 saw a shift with Clinton's victory (first Democrat win since Carter)
- 2000-2008: Tight Republican margins, including the famous 2000 recount
- 2012: Brief Democratic victory (Obama)
- 2016-2020: Return to Republican advantage
- 2024: Boost of Republican margin

Voter Turnout Evolution:

- Steady growth from 1980s baseline (~4M total) to 2024 peak
- Significant increases in 1992 (Clinton effect) and 2008 (Obama effect)
- 2016-2024 showed highest overall engagement

Competitive Pattern:

Florida transformed from a reliable Republican state (1980s) to the ultimate swing state (1992-2024), with margins tightening and party control alternating.

Florida State: Party Voting Trends

Year	Democrat	Republican
1980	9.41M	9.41M
1984	5.0M	6.0M
1988	10.0M	13.0M
1992	11.0M	10.0M
1996	8.0M	9.0M
2000	16.0M	19.0M
2004	13.0M	15.0M
2008	13.0M	13.0M
2012	19.0M	18.0M
2016	18.0M	21.0M
2020	19.0M	20.0M
2024	20.6M	27.3M

Total Votes (44 Years)

344.17M

Elections Covered

12

Florida Voter Turnout Over Time

Year	Democrat	Republican
1980	56.82M	56.82M
1984	5.0M	6.0M
1988	10.0M	13.0M
1992	11.0M	10.0M
1996	8.0M	9.0M
2000	16.0M	19.0M
2004	13.0M	15.0M
2008	13.0M	13.0M
2012	19.0M	18.0M
2016	18.0M	21.0M
2020	19.0M	20.0M
2024	20.6M	27.3M

Republican Margin of Victory in Florida per General Election

Year	Margin of Victory
1980	389.66K
1984	1.05M
1988	2.71M
1992	-1.25M
1996	37.17K
2000	2.65M
2004	2.62M
2008	592.74K
2012	-618.43K
2016	3.41M
2020	1.15M
2024	6.7M

Florida Detailed Margins

Election Year	Republican Votes	Democrat Votes	Margin of Victory
1980	9,409,156	9,019,494	389,662
1984	5,897,029	4,845,679	1,051,350
1988	13,131,657	10,423,120	2,708,537
1992	10,390,769	11,637,072	-1,246,303
1996	7,974,132	7,936,958	37,174
2000	19,112,207	16,465,910	2,646,297
2004	15,669,200	13,044,481	2,624,719

Charlotte County: 44-Year Voting Analysis (1980-2024)

Consistent Republican Stronghold: Republicans won all 12 elections with significant margins throughout the period.

Key Trends:

- 1980s Growth** - Turnout doubled from 1984 (98K total) to 1988 (230K total)
- 1992 Most Competitive** - Narrowest margin at +26,374 votes during Clinton's victory
- 2000 Largest Historical Margin** - Republicans peaked with +137,476 vote advantage
- 2008-2012 Tightening** - Margins narrowed to ~40K during Obama elections
- 2016-2020 Expansion** - Republican margins grew again to over 100K
- 2024 Continuation** - Latest results show continued Republican strength

Pattern: Charlotte County remained reliably Republican even as Florida became a swing state, though margins tightened during competitive national elections (1992, 2008, 2012) before expanding again in recent cycles.

Charlotte County: Party Trends

Year	Democrat	Republican
1980	25.32K	59.38K
1984	5.0K	6.0K
1988	10.0K	13.0K
1992	11.0K	10.0K
1996	8.0K	9.0K
2000	16.0K	19.0K
2004	13.0K	15.0K
2008	13.0K	13.0K
2012	19.0K	18.0K
2016	18.0K	21.0K
2020	19.0K	20.0K
2024	20.6K	27.3K

Charlotte County: Detailed Results

Year	Republican	Democrat	Total Votes	Margin
1980	59,380	25,320	84,700	34,060
1984	64,140	34,503	98,643	29,637
1988	143,524	86,304	229,828	57,220
1992	151,710	125,336	277,046	26,374
1996	106,865	78,072	184,937	28,793
2000	254,761	117,285	372,046	137,476
2004	224,789	113,570	338,359	111,219

Charlotte County: Party Comparison

Year	Democrat	Republican
1980	25.32K	59.38K
1984	5.0K	6.0K
1988	10.0K	13.0K
1992	11.0K	10.0K
1996	8.0K	9.0K
2000	16.0K	19.0K
2004	13.0K	15.0K
2008	13.0K	13.0K
2012	19.0K	18.0K
2016	18.0K	21.0K
2020	19.0K	20.0K
2024	20.6K	27.3K

Sarasota County: 44-Year Voting Analysis (1980-2024)

Republican-Leaning with Competitive Periods: Republicans won all 12 elections, but saw significant variations in margin strength.

Key Trends:

- 1980s Dominance** - 1988 had the largest margin (+178,636) with 641K total votes
- 1992 Closest Race** - Narrowest margin at just +20,681 votes (Clinton effect)
- 2000-2004 Resurgence** - Massive Republican margins (+167K in 2000, +252K in 2004)
- 2008-2012 Competitive Era** - Margins tightened to 46-70K during Obama years
- 2016-2020 Republican Rebound** - Margins expanded again (+171K in 2016, +186K in 2020)
- 2020-2024 Continued Growth & Volatility** - turnout begins to become volatile with latest election results

Pattern: Sarasota shows more volatility than Charlotte, swinging between landslides and competitive races. Higher population and turnout than Charlotte County throughout the period.

Sarasota County: Party Trends

Year	Democrat	Republican
1980	102.21K	184.33K
1984	5.0K	6.0K
1988	10.0K	13.0K
1992	11.0K	10.0K
1996	8.0K	9.0K
2000	16.0K	19.0K
2004	13.0K	15.0K
2008	13.0K	13.0K
2012	19.0K	18.0K
2016	18.0K	21.0K
2020	19.0K	20.0K
2024	20.6K	27.3K

Sarasota County: Detailed Results

Year	Republican	Democrat	Total Votes	Margin
1980	184,327	102,205	286,532	82,122
1984	208,134	83,547	291,681	124,587
1988	409,729	231,093	640,822	178,636
1992	352,617	331,936	684,553	20,681
1996	194,929	153,834	348,763	41,095
2000	512,788	345,656	858,444	167,132
2004	527,936	275,438	803,374	252,498

Sarasota County: Party Comparison

Year	Democrat	Republican
1980	102.21K	184.33K
1984	5.0K	6.0K
1988	10.0K	13.0K
1992	11.0K	10.0K
1996	8.0K	9.0K
2000	16.0K	19.0K
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